

**SOLUTIONS³**

Cyberside Chats: Summer Edition

Weekly Recap

Special points of interest:

- Should companies pay Ransomware attacks?
- Microsoft SharePoint zero-day exploit over the weekend
- Falconi suffers data breach
- FileFlix: a new social engineering attack that leverages user trust

Welcome to the 8th issue of our Cybersecurity Internship Newsletter!

This week, Solutions³ LLC launched the first phase of the Risk Management Framework (RMF) Pathway during our weekly kick-off meeting. This week's theme was identifying and understanding organizational risks through frameworks and reconnaissance. To put this into practice, interns collaborated to create a risk register and a reconnaissance findings summary for Falconi.

The interns also had a very thought-provoking Professional Development session led by Mark Marino, which focused on Ethical Decision-Making. We explored a 5-step model that highlighted recognition

of an ethical issue, working toward effective solutions, as well as adapting for future choices. Using this model, the interns were tasked to categorize multiple scenarios as either ethical or unethical.

This week's Vendor of the Week Session, hosted by Cintia Takeda from Hacker Rangers, demonstrated how the gamification of technical security concepts can make learning more impactful and fun. Hacker Rangers provides interactive phishing simulations, a creative reward system to encourage high participation, and much more.

To close off the week, the interns participated in the Hack the Box Power Hour hosted by Floyd Hanes, where they built their skills in information gathering through



various web reconnaissance activities. The interns had a blast using tools like who.is and the Wayback Machine to dig into domain records and uncover valuable insights.

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Vendor of the Week

Interns had the privilege to speak with Cintia Takeda from the gamification security awareness program, Hacker Rangers. Hacker Rangers delivers a unique product that teaches users to recognize and report cybersecurity threats. Cintia gave a brief history of the organization and explained the process of

building contracts and training modules for clients. She cited one of Hacker Rangers' biggest assets as their understanding of the human psychology and reward system. This knowledge has allowed for an interactive platform that encourages employees to compete against each other as they rise through the leaderboard ranks.

Additionally, Cintia highlighted future plans for Hacker Rangers' expansion and answered questions interns had. Overall, the interns enjoyed the opportunity to speak with Cintia and look forward to watching Hacker Rangers expand!



Inside Cyber Claims

When a company is hit with a cyberattack, it often turns to its insurer for help. According to a recent report by Marsh McLennan, “21% of clients that purchased a cyber policy reported an event in 2023”. Additionally, in the same year, Marsh clients across the US and Canada filed over 1,800 cyber claims, which was the highest number to date. A prevalent component in cyber claims is ransomware. These attacks can encrypt systems or threaten to leak sensitive data

unless a ransom is paid. Ransomware is on the rise and can be incredibly damaging for an organization and insurers can assist the hacked organization in paying a ransom. Should they?

Critics argue that paying ransoms only fuels the business model of cybercriminals, while supporters say it’s sometimes the only option to resume operations quickly and protect stakeholders. Either way, the surge in claims highlights a crucial point – com-

panies need more than insurance. They must invest in prevention, response planning, and trusted partners. Cybersecurity is a long game.

“This campaign is not opportunistic — it is deliberate, capable, and designed for persistence even after patching.”

When Friday Plans Met ToolShell: SharePoint RCE Hits Hard, Cyber Teams Pulled Back into Action

Just as we, and industry pros alike, were mentally logging off and convincing ourselves it could finally be a quiet weekend, ToolShell (CVE-2025-53770) showed up: an unauthenticated remote code execution zero-day in Microsoft SharePoint. The exploit kicked off on Friday, July 18, targeting on-prem servers around the globe. Threat actors wasted no time, dropping

web shells and stealing machine keys while defenders were still brewing their weekend coffee.

By Sunday, it was clear this wasn’t a small incident, vendors and government agencies were confirming active exploitation across federal networks, universities, and private-sector environments. Microsoft rolled out emergency patches by Monday, July 21, covering SharePoint 2016, 2019, and Subscription

Edition, but in many cases, the damage was already done: lateral movement had begun, and patching won’t kick them out.

We didn’t have to jump in, but we definitely took notes: zero-days don’t care what day it is.

Falconi Data Breach



On July 15, 2025, our sports agency Falconi suffered a data breach after a brute force attack on its backup server. The attacker gained access using weak credentials and quickly exfiltrated sensitive files, including internal SSH passwords and cloud storage locations within the com-

pany. This enabled further access to approximately 20 GB of archival data. The breach triggered an immediate incident response, including isolating the server, rotating credentials, and deploying effective security controls. No customer data was confirmed exposed, but internal

documentation and an employee email were compromised, raising phishing risks. Falconi has since resolved the issue and implemented long-term measures to prevent future breaches, remaining vigilant against future threats.

Professional Development Series: Ethical Decision-Making

This week's professional development session, hosted by Mark Marino, focused on ethical decision-making in cybersecurity. Interns explored the role of ethics in the workplace and learned how personal values and professional responsibilities intersect in cybersecurity environments.

The session introduced a 5-step ethical decision-making model: recognizing the ethical issue, gathering facts, evaluating options, making and testing the

decision, and reflecting on the outcome. This framework helped interns think critically about scenarios involving data privacy, unauthorized access, vulnerability disclosure, favoritism, and confidentiality. Interns also discussed the difference between personal and professional ethics and how cybersecurity professionals must uphold standards of transparency, accountability, and integrity, especially when given privileged access to sensitive systems and data. Interactive

activities such as the "Ethical Speed Round Icebreaker," "Scenario Triad," and the "Ethics Sorting Game" allowed interns to evaluate workplace scenarios and reflect on how ethical behavior can impact team culture.

The session concluded with a reminder that ethical decisions aren't just about avoiding harm. They're about doing what's right, even when it's inconvenient.



FileFlix: A new social engineering attack

Most people know not to click on suspicious links, but the newly discovered FileFix attack doesn't need you to. Instead, it tricks users into copying and pasting. Researchers at Check Point found that malicious websites can open a Windows File Explorer window and silently copy a dangerous PowerShell command to your clipboard. If you paste it into the address bar,

the command runs instantly, no clicking or downloading required.

What makes FileFix so dangerous is how routine the action of copying and pasting is to users. At its core, it's a social engineering attacker that exploits our everyday habits. To stay safe, be cautious of websites that say they can fix issues or ask you to paste things into system tools.

When in doubt, stop and verify with someone or look up the source. Ultimately, awareness is your best defense against social engineering tricks like this.

"FileFix does not exploit software vulnerabilities; instead, it leverages user trust"

Did You Know?

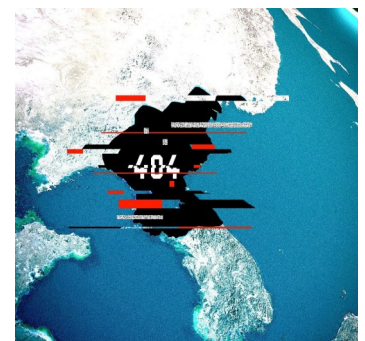
In 2022, North Korea experienced a major shutdown to one of their critical infrastructures; their entire internet.

Alejandro Caceres, better known as P4x, single-handedly took down their entire internet with little to no resistance. P4x targeted all servers hosting North Ko-

rea's websites and email services using a DDoS attack.

Not only did Alejandro notice how outdated and weak the infrastructure was, but he also noted how there was no incident response at all; the internet only came back when he allowed it to come back.

When asked what takeaways nation-states should take from this attack, Alejandro noted that a small group of people have the potential to take down an entire country, "they're just another target and we know how to deal with that."



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At Solutions³ LLC, we believe that empowering people is the key to sustainable success in cybersecurity, IT, and business service management as a whole. Our commitment to resource development is evident through mentorships, advanced training, and workforce development programs, including impactful internships and apprenticeships.

For more information on our internships, workforce development, or training, contact Mike Battistella at mike@solutions3llc.com or Shannon Conley at shannon.conley@solutions3llc.com.

Special Thanks to Our Sponsors

We are grateful for the generous support and partnership of the following organizations, whose contributions help make the Summer Cybersecurity Internship Program possible. Their support enables us to provide hands-on learning experiences, real-world simulations, and invaluable mentorship opportunities for our interns.



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Editor's Corner

Thank you for reading the 8th edition of our Cyberside Chats Newsletter!

I can't believe it's been eight weeks since I started working alongside my fellow interns and the amazing team at Solutions³. I wasn't sure what to expect for my first internship, but I'm incredibly grateful for the chance to grow through the three learning pathways, both in technical training and professional development.

A huge thank you to Mike Battistella, Mark Marino, Shannon Conley, and Kristen Nova for supporting us and challenging us to think critically. Their willingness and enthusiasm to

answer any questions we have about their careers or give us insights into this field has been amazing. I really appreciate the creative freedom we've had to explore these pathways through our mock company "Falconi," which has helped us improve our knowledge in a fun and meaningful way.

I'm also thankful for our weekly vendors for sharing their platforms and advice with us. A special shoutout to Floyd Haynes, whose passion, guidance, and energy have pushed us to be better each week.

Finally, this internship wouldn't have been the same without my fellow interns. Thank you to

Dominick, Andre, Amaan, Aaron, Julia, John, Jaylen, and Bryan for bringing your perspectives, energy, and creativity to everything we've done. I've learned so much from each of you and can't wait to meet you all!

- Jesus Ochoa Gonzalez

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